

Tandem — the social app for doing things together

The Problem

People are lonelier than ever. Social media made us more connected and less close. Everyone has 800 friends online and nobody to go climbing with on Saturday.

The existing platforms are built for broadcasting, not for meeting. You scroll, you consume, you close the app feeling worse.

Our Solution

Tandem is built around activities, not profiles. You post something you want to do — a hike, a chess game, a language exchange — and people nearby join. No feed, no likes, no follower counts.

The whole design philosophy is that the app should get you off the app. Success for us is a user who opens Tandem twice a week and spends four minutes in it.

The Market

Two billion people use social apps daily. Loneliness is a documented public health crisis in a dozen countries, and governments are starting to fund responses to it. The opportunity to build something genuinely good here is enormous.

Competition

Meetup is fifteen years old and feels it. Facebook Groups is where activities go to die. Dating apps have the discovery mechanic but the wrong intent.

We think there is room for something built for this from scratch.

Traction

- 18,000 downloads since launch in April
- 4,100 monthly active users
- 6,200 activities posted, 3,900 of which had at least one joiner
- strong qualitative feedback: our Discord is full of people who have made real friends

We are growing entirely by word of mouth in three cities.

The Team

Lior Ben-Ami is a product designer who has wanted to build this for years. Sanne Vermeer previously worked in community management.

Four people.

Business Model

We have deliberately not monetised yet. Putting ads or subscriptions into a product about genuine human connection would undermine the thing that makes it work, and we would rather grow the community first and figure out revenue once we have real density.

There are several obvious directions — premium features, partnerships with venues, local business listings — and we will explore them when the time is right.

Funding

We are raising €2.5M to expand to eight cities and grow the team to twelve.